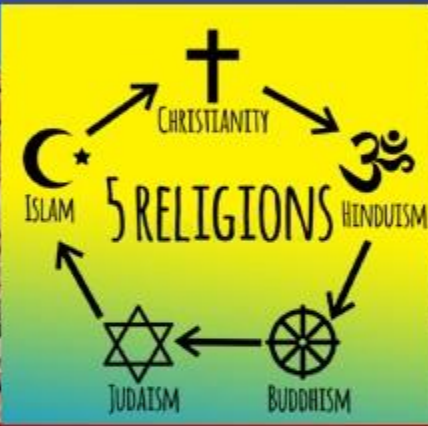


ART & CULTURE



INDIAN PAINTINGS

MODULE - 5

MINIATURE PAINTINGS

MINIATURE PAINTINGS

5

MUGHAL ERA SCHOOL

- 1 Babur established the Mughal Dynasty after fighting a series of war.
- 2 He did not have much time to commission paintings, but he is said to have patronized the Persian artist called Bihzad who made some illustrations of the Mughal family tree.
- 3 Humayun who was made a great patron of arts came to the throne at a young age.
- 4 He was interested in paintings and building beautiful monuments, but his atelier was disrupted when he lost the throne to Sher Shah Suri and was exiled to Persia.
- 5 While he was at Shah Abba's court in Persia, he acquired the services of two main painters called Abdus Sammad (or Abd-al Sammad) and Mir Saeed Ali, who came back with him after he won his throne back and established the Mughal Dynasty in India.
- 6 These artists were responsible for bringing Persian influence in the Mughal paintings and created many successful illustrated albums.

MINIATURE PAINTINGS

5

MUGHAL ERA SCHOOL

AKBAR



The Parrot addresses Khojasta,
a scene from the Tuti-Nama.

- 1 Akbar was responsible for establishment of an entire department devoted to the paintings and scribing of his documents.
- 2 He established **Karkhanas or workshops** where the artists developed their own styles. **Akbar looked upon paintings as a means of study and amusement.**
- 3 He believed that the painting could show the demeanour of the subject and regularly gave awards to those painters who created lifelike images.

MINIATURE PAINTINGS

5

MUGHAL ERA SCHOOL

AKBAR

4 Akbar also recognized the beauty of those Indian artists who had worked for previous rulers and invited them to work in his Karkhanas. Hence, the “Indian Influence” started in the Mughal paintings.

5 The defining features of paintings in Akbar’s period are the **use of 3 dimensional figures and the continued use of foreshortening.**

6 Furthermore, the artists encouraged the use of calligraphy in the paintings.

7 One of the distinguishing features of this period was the **transformation of popular art to the court art.** i.e the artist was more focused at depicting the scenes of the court life than the life of the masses. .

8 Famous painters of this period include **Daswant, Basawan and Kesu.**

MINIATURE PAINTINGS

5

MUGHAL ERA SCHOOL

JAHANGIR



Emperor Jahangir weighs
Prince Khurram

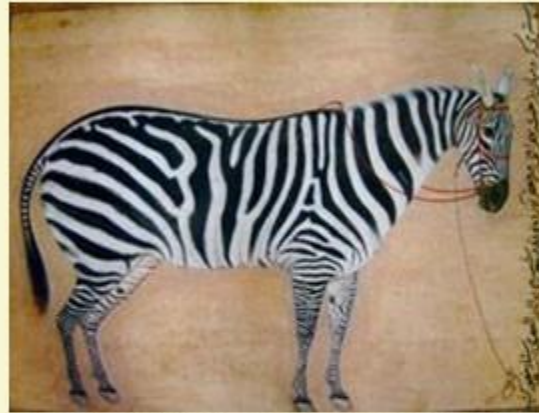
- 1 The Mughal paintings reached its zenith in the period of Jahangir.
- 2 He was a **naturalist by nature** and preferred the paintings of flora and fauna i.e birds, animals, trees and flowers.
- 3 He emphasised on bringing naturalism to **portrait painting**.
- 4 One of the unique trends that developed in this period was of **decorated margins around the paintings** that were sometimes as elaborate as the paintings themselves.

MINIATURE PAINTINGS

5

MUGHAL ERA SCHOOL

JAHANGIR



5

Jahangir was himself considered to be a good artist and he had his own private workshop although no major work by him survives.

6

His atelier mostly created miniature paintings of the Zebra, the Turkey and the cock.

7

One of the most famous artist from his period is **Ustad Mansoor** who was an expert in drawing the features of the most complex faces.

Miniature works of Ustad Mansur

MINIATURE PAINTINGS

5

MUGHAL ERA SCHOOL

SHAH JAHAN



**The Emperor Shah Jahan
standing on a globe**

- 1** The tenor of the Mughal paintings changed rapidly in the period of Shah Jahan.
- 2** Unlike his father and grandfather who like naturalistic depictions, Shah Jahan like to create artificial elements in the paintings.
- 3** It is said that he tried to reduce the liveliness of the paintings and bring in unnatural stillness as he was inspired by the European Influence in his court.

MINIATURE PAINTINGS

5

MUGHAL ERA SCHOOL

SHAH JAHAN



Shah Jahan on a terrace holding
a pendant set with his portrait

4

He has brought change in the technique of drawing and painting from the earlier period.

5

He eschewed the use of charcoal to draw and encouraged the artists to draw and sketch using a pencil. He also ordered to heightened use of gold and silver in the paintings.

6

He also liked brighter color palettes as compared to his predecessors. Hence, we can say that the Mughal atelier was enlarged during his reign but changed a lot in style and technique.

MINIATURE PAINTINGS

REGIONAL SCHOOLS OF ART

- 1) The Pala School
- 2) Western Indian School
- 3) Other Isolated Styles
- 4) The Mughal School
- 5) The Deccani School
 - a) Ahmednagar
 - b) Bijapur
 - c) Golkonda
 - d) Hyderabad
 - e) Tanjore
- 6) The Central India and Rajasthani school
 - a) Malwa
 - b) Mewar
 - c) Burdi
 - d) Kota
 - e) Amber-Jaipur
 - f) Marwar
 - g) Bikaner
 - h) Kishangarh
- 7) The Pahari School
 - a) Basholi
 - b) Guler
 - c) Kangra
 - d) Kulu-Mandi
- 8) The Orissa School

1 Even though the medieval period was dominated by the Mughal style of painting the sub-imperial schools developed a space for themselves by developing their own styles.

2 They remembered their Indian roots and penchant for colorful paintings as opposed to the more naturalistic Mughal style.

MINIATURE PAINTINGS

6 RAJASTHANI SCHOOL OF PAINTING

- 1 The Rajasthani School of painting is more or less synonymous to the Rajput school of paintings as they were the dominant ruling class in this period and patronized most of the artists.
- 2 How does the phenomenon of Rajput painting come about and what are its sources?
- 3 Some say Rajput courts began to patronise painting in emulation of the practices of the Mughal court.
- 4 Moreover, it was the arrival in Bikaner, Jodhpur or Kishangarh of artists from the Mughal atelier that sowed the seeds of local Rajput schools. Others say that the influx of artists and artworks from the Deccan sultanates played a decisive role.
- 5 Yet others say that local and indigenous artistic traditions pre-dated the arrival of Mughal influence in these centres.
- 6 There are several subgenres of Rajasthani paintings which correspond to their princely State of origin.

MINIATURE PAINTINGS

6 RAJASTHANI SCHOOL OF PAINTING

FACTORS RELATING TO DEVELOPMENT OF RAJASTHANI PAINTINGS

- Two major factors contributed greatly to the development of Rajasthani Paintings.
- First, the **commercial community** of Rajputana was economically prosperous.
- Second, **the revival of 'Vaishnavism'** and **the growth of Bhakti cult** provided a direction to the development of a distinct school.
- The influence of poets and seers like **Ramanuja** (worshipper of Vishnu) in the 14th century and writers like **Jaydev** (worshipper of Krishna) greatly influenced thinking, spiritual awakening and art of the people of large parts of India.
- The Rajasthani School, akin to many others, was influenced greatly by the advent of **Ramananda, Tulsidas, Kabir**, etc.
- This is how the subjects of the Rajput paintings included the Sri Ram Charit Manas, Geet-Govinda, the divine love of Radha and Krishna, ancient tales, lives of saints, and Ragamala and religious texts such as the Ramayana, Mahabharata, Bhagvat Purana, Krishna Lila etc.

MINIATURE PAINTINGS

6 RAJASTHANI SCHOOL OF PAINTING



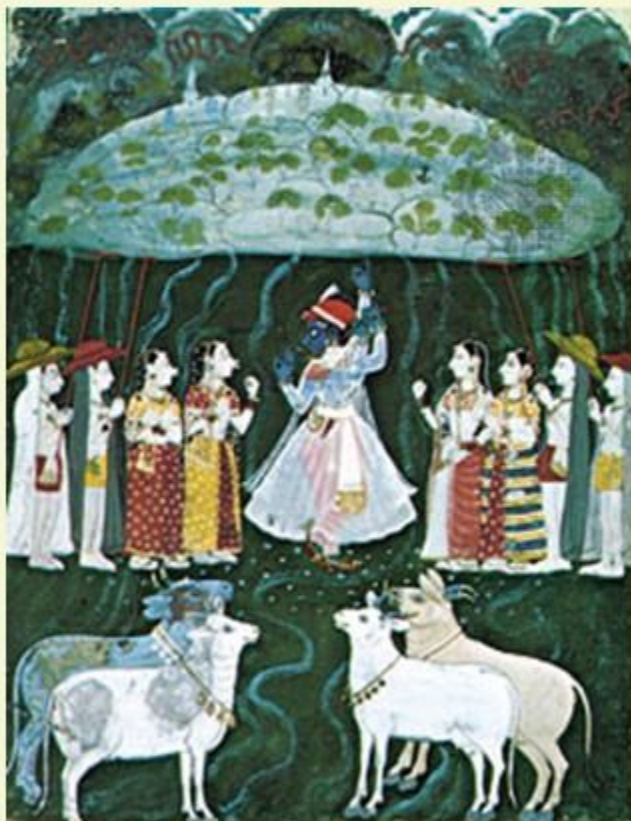
FACTORS RELATING TO DEVELOPMENT OF RAJASTHANI PAINTINGS

- The matrimonial alliances of the Rajputs with Mughals brought about the interesting and important changes in the various styles of paintings.
- These changes were visible in the dress designs, architectural details, art motifs, landscape patterns and the choice of subject matter.

MINIATURE PAINTINGS

6. a)

MEWAR SCHOOL OF PAINTING



Krishna Lifting Mount Govardhana

1

The kingdom of Mewar resisted Mughal suzerainty for the longest time, eventually acceding to Mughal power in the reign of Shah Jahan.

2

The kingdom's capital moved from Ranthambore and Chittogarh as these forts fell to shifting bases in the wilderness.

3

Later in more peaceful times, the city of Udaipur was established.

MINIATURE PAINTINGS

6. a)

MEWAR SCHOOL OF PAINTING



An example of a work by Sahibdin. It depicts Krishna and Radha in a bower, a scene from a dispersed Gita Govinda.

4 Mewar rulers seem to have patronized art even in times of adversity, though the years of relative peace and prosperity saw an extraordinary efflorescence.

5 If one look at the early Mewar painting, we shall realize it is dominated by the extraordinary figure of Sahibdin.

6 This period of Mewari painting focuses on Sahibdin's depiction of literary texts like the Rasikapriya, the Ramayana and Bhagavata Purana.

MINIATURE PAINTINGS

6. a)

MEWAR SCHOOL OF PAINTING



7 After Sahibdin's death, the style of Mewari paintings changed. **Most of the paintings depicted the life at court in Mewar.**

8 The unique point of this period is the extraordinary "**tamasha**" paintings that show **court ceremonial and city views** in unprecedented detail.

MINIATURE PAINTINGS

6. a)

MEWAR SCHOOL OF PAINTING

IMPORTANT FEATURES OF MEWAR PAINTINGS

- 1** In these paintings, bright and brilliant red, orange, green, bright-blue colours have been profusely used.
- 2** Male and female figures have long noses, oval shaped faces, elongated fish-like eyes.
- 3** The female figures have been drawn relatively smaller than the male.
- 4** The males use loose fitting garments embroidered Patka and Turbans and the females use loose long skirts, choli and transparent odhnis (veils).
- 5** The paintings of the birds, animals and trees are ornate, the flowers drawn in bunches, and the Hills and Mountains depicted in Persian style. Small hillocks and mounds have been inserted into the paintings.

MINIATURE PAINTINGS

6. a)

MEWAR SCHOOL OF PAINTING

SUB-STYLES OF MEWAR

The Nathdwara sub-style, Devgarh Sub-style and the Shahpura sub-style have developed from the Mewar style.

NATHDWARA PAINTINGS



1

Nathdwara is a place near Udaipur, where the famous Shrinath Ji temple of 17th century is located. Shrinathji is a 14th-century, 7-year-old “infant” incarnation of Krishna.

2

The idol was originally worshipped at Mathura but was shifted in 1672 from Govardhan hill, near Mathura and retained at Agra for almost six months, in order to protect it from the men of Aurangzeb.

MINIATURE PAINTINGS

6. a) MEWAR SCHOOL OF PAINTING

NATHDWARA PAINTINGS



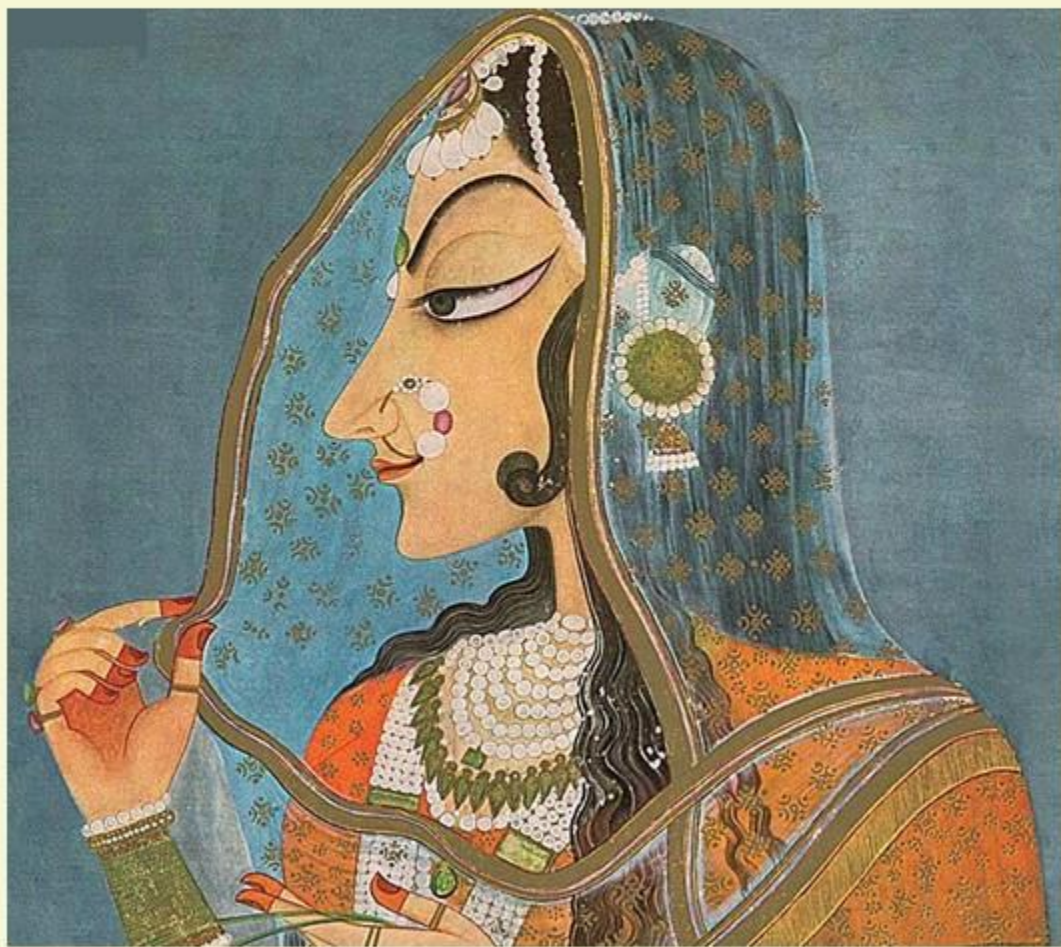
Pichkai paintings

- 3 Obviously, there was an amalgamation of the cultural traditions of the Braj and Mewar and that reflects in the Nathdwara school of paintings.
- 4 Here, a notable point is that the Pichhwai paintings are a type of the wall paintings of Nathdwara style.
- 5 The main theme of the Nathdwara style is Krishna and his leelas.

MINIATURE PAINTINGS

6. b)

KISHANGARH SCHOOL



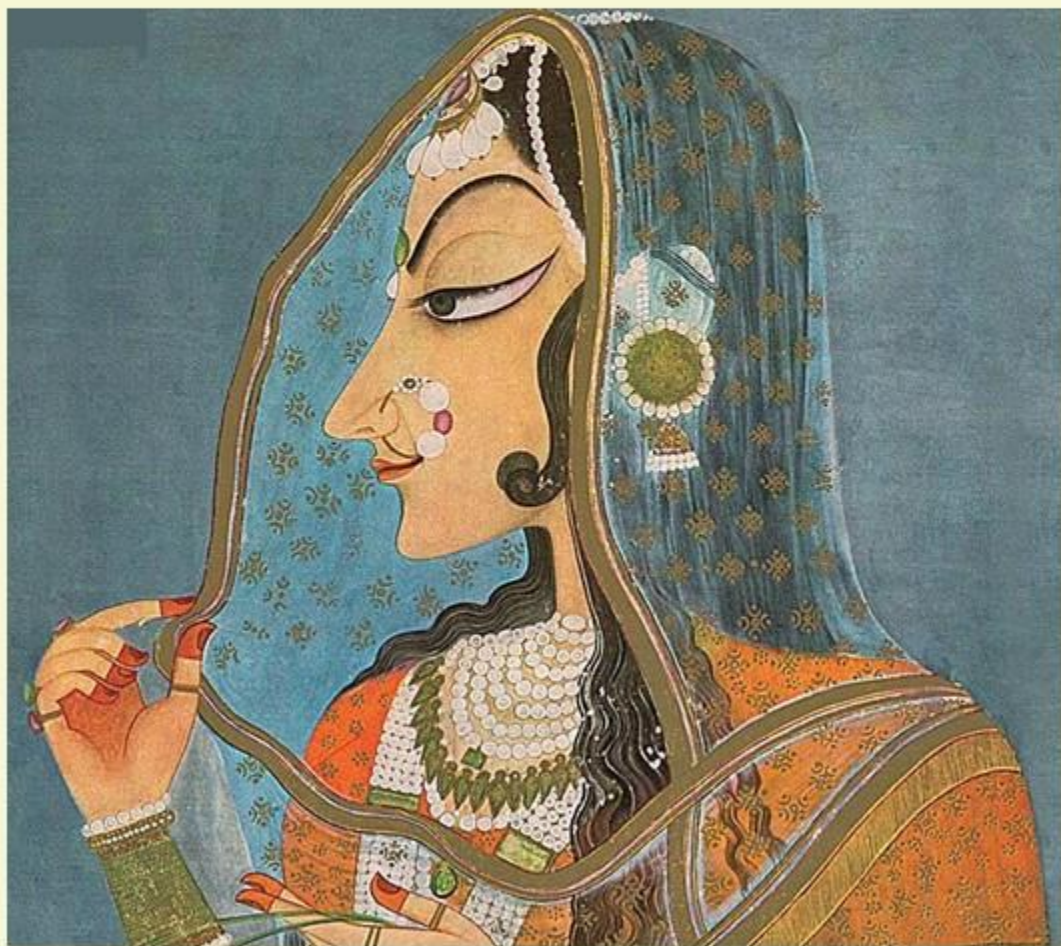
Bani Thani also known as Indian Monalisa

- 1 Painting at Kishangarh is associated with most romantic legends of Sawant Singh and his beloved Bani Thani and of the intertwining of lives and myths, romance and bhakti.
- 2 The developments of Kishangarh school closely relates to the interplay of the famous trio- Sawant Singh the prince and lover, Nagari Das the poet and Nihal Chand the painter- who created some of the most legendary paintings by this school.
- 3 It is sometimes argued that the woman in “Bani Thani” is said to resemble the character of Radha.

MINIATURE PAINTINGS

6. b)

KISHANGARH SCHOOL



Bani Thani also known as Indian Monalisa

4 She has a distinctive profile and has large and lustrous eyes, thin lips and a pointed chin. Her odhni or headgear defines her side profile. This became the unique painting associated with the Kishangarh School.

5 They also made many paintings on the devotional and amorous relations between Radha and Krishna.

6 In fact, the romantic life of Radha and Krishna, influenced by the Geet-Govinda of Jaydev is one of favourite subjects of the Kishangarh painters.

MINIATURE PAINTINGS

6. c)

BUNDI SCHOOL OF PAINTING



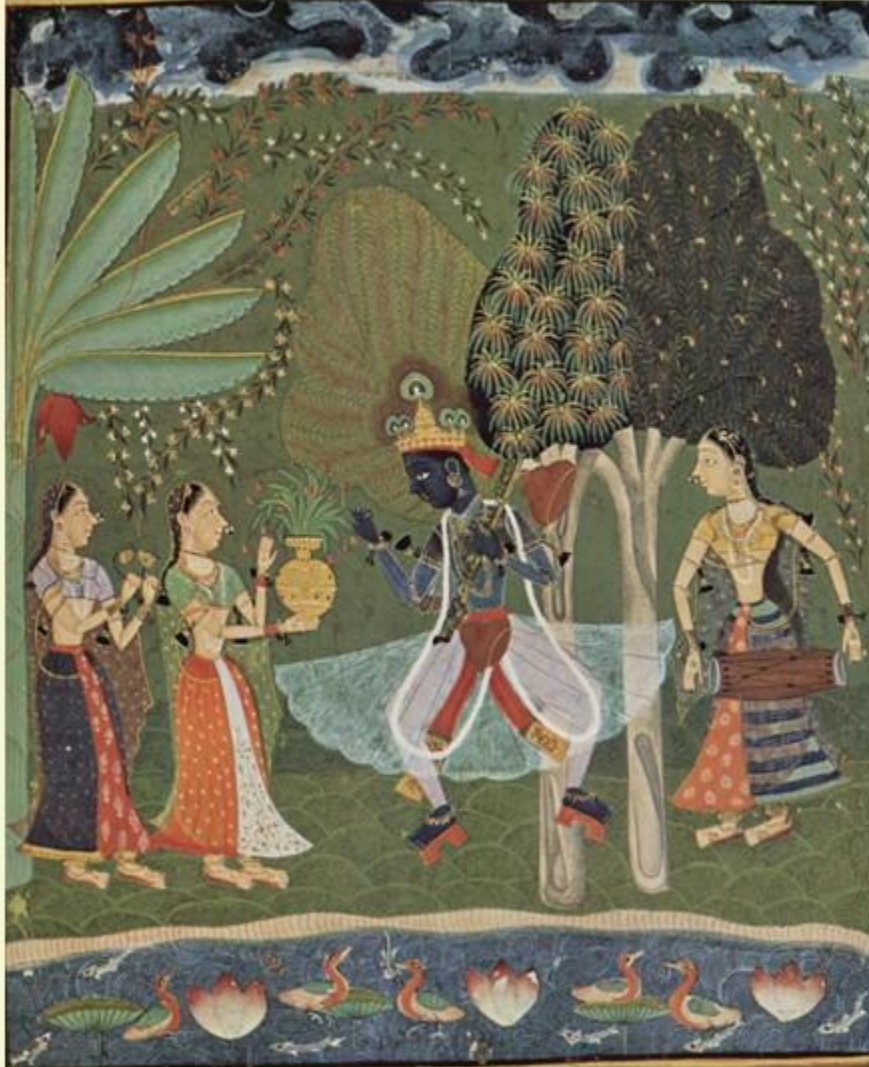
Krishna and the gopis

- 1 The twin kingdoms of Bundi and Kota are collectively known as Hadoti.
- 2 The sister States, formed by splitting the older Bundi Kingdom between two brothers, have closely intertwined histories and artistic traditions.

MINIATURE PAINTINGS

6. c)

BUNDI SCHOOL OF PAINTING



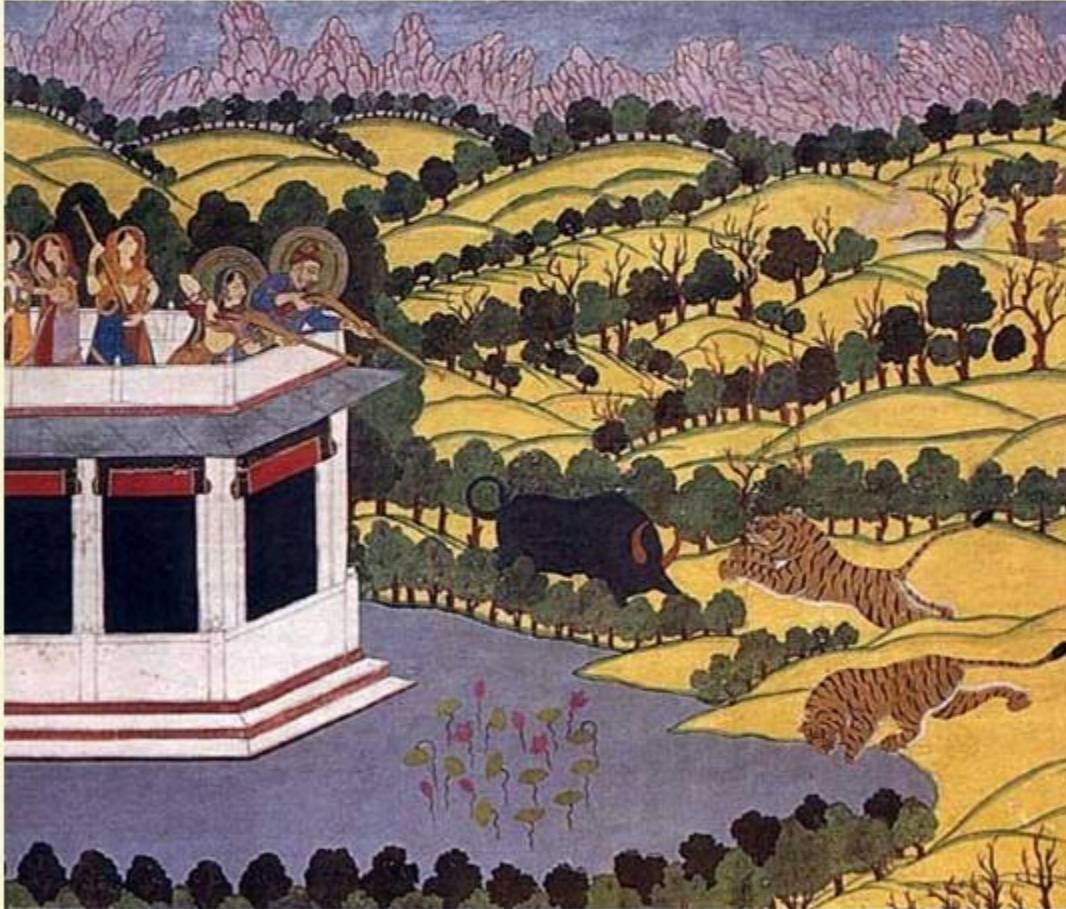
Krishna dances to the music of girls

- 3** Bundi and Kota's kings were devout devotees of Krishna and in the 8th century. They declared themselves to be mere regents, ruling on behalf of the god who was the true king (similar patterns of worship are seen in several other centres, including Udaipur and Jaipur).
- 4** Their Krishna-bhakti plays a major role in this school of painting

MINIATURE PAINTINGS

6. c)

BUNDI SCHOOL OF PAINTING



- 5 In addition, we will see the special paintings made for later rulers including Rao Ram Singh II.
- 6 In Bundi school, paintings of local vegetation were in detail.
- 7 Human faces were more rounded with pointed nose in the paintings.

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